

Moodle Dashboard

Once you log into Moodle, you are at the Moodle **Dashboard**. Other names given to the Dashboard include Landing Page and Home Page. The Dashboard has links to important tools, resources and documents as well as your courses. Dashboards vary depending upon how an institution sets up the Dashboard (what defaults are set in place), and how an instructor or student customizes their Dashboard. In this document, we will review the basic set-up of a dashboard.

Contents

- Dashboard

Side blocks

- Changing position of the side blocks
- Adding/deleting side blocks

Default Side Blocks and Navigation Pane All

- Calendar
- Navigation Pane
- Upcoming events

Default Side Blocks Students

- Moodle Help
- NorQuest Links

Center Blocks

- Course overview

Tabs

- Library
- My Quest
- MyMail
- Technical Support
- Notifications and Messages
- User Preferences and Profile

Dashboard

Navigation Pane

Courses

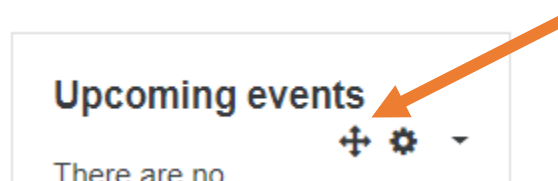
Dashboard Side Blocks

Dashboard Side Blocks are to the right of the Dashboard. Unlike previous versions of Moodle, blocks are only featured on the right hand side or at the bottom of the page (if you minimize your browser enough or are using a mobile device).

Changing the order of side blocks for the Dashboard to suit you is easily done.

To move the side blocks:

1. Select **Customize this page** at the top right of the Dashboard.
2. Editing icons will appear. The crosshairs icon allows you to drag the side block where you would like it.



- When you are satisfied with the location of the side blocks, select **Stop customizing this page**. If you want to reset the Dashboard to the original default, select **Reset page to default**.

Reset page to default

Stop customising this page

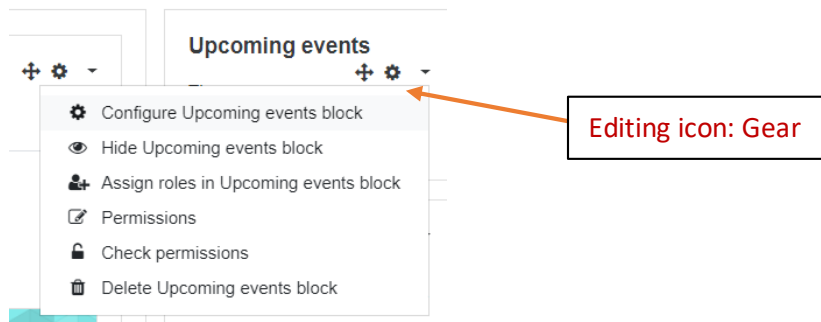
Note: You may also move side blocks by Configuring (editing) side blocks. See below.

Adding/deleting side blocks may also be something an instructor would like to consider. Contemplate adding and deleting side blocks after using Moodle for a period of time. One should have a good understanding of the features of Moodle and be able to decipher which tools and resources are particularly useful. Note: When instructors change side blocks for a Dashboard, it does not affect the students' Dashboards; however, changing the Course side blocks does. A rule to follow for both a Dashboard and a Course page: If you do not use a side block, delete it. This allows one (instructor and student alike) to focus on the relevant material in Moodle.

To delete side blocks:

- Select **Customize this page** at the top right of the Dashboard.
- Icons will appear. Select the editing icon, the gear, to get a drop down menu. You may choose to edit the side block by selecting the **Configure block** (you may edit the side block location), **Hide the block** or **Delete the block**.

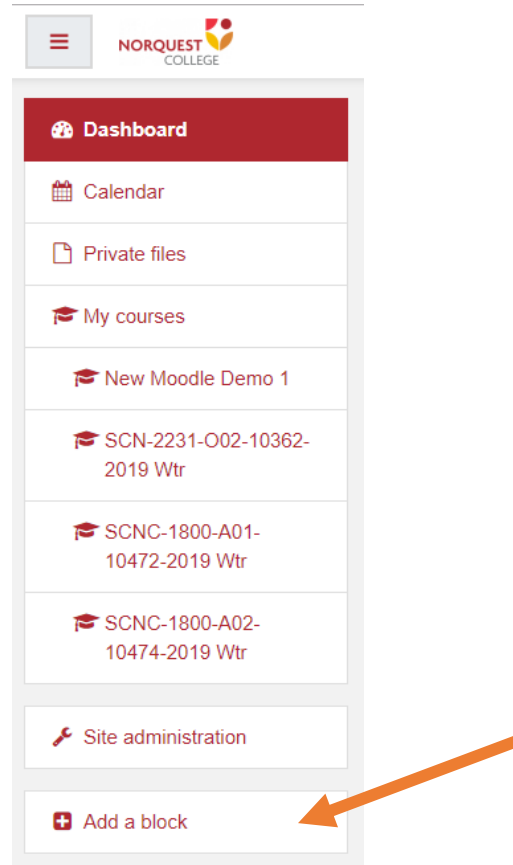
Customise this page



- To delete a side block** select **Delete (Name) block**. When you are satisfied with the side blocks and their locations select **Stop customizing this page** at the top right of your Dashboard. If you want to reset the Dashboard to the original default, select **Reset page to default**.

To add side blocks:

1. To add a side block, click on the **hamburger button** on the top left to open the **Navigation Pane**. Scroll to the bottom of the pane. An **Add a Block** block appears only when the **Customize this page** is activated. Click on this block to open the block menu.



4. When you are satisfied with the location and selection of the side blocks, select **Stop customizing this page**. If you want to reset the Dashboard to the original default (including original blocks), select **Reset page to default**.

Reset page to default

Stop customising this page

Default Side Blocks and Navigation Pane All (Instructors and Students)

Calendar: The calendar should appear at the top right of your Dashboard by default.

The calendar is one of the most important tools for students. The Dashboard Calendar displays all events identified, for all their courses. Students may use their Dashboard Calendar as a study and time management tool.

Course events are inputted in two ways. 1. If an instructor creates an activity in Moodle with dates (Forum, Assignment, Quiz, etc.), the dates identified in the settings when creating these activities automatically populate the calendar. 2. If an instructor has important course activities such as a guest speaker, an instructor may add these events to the calendar. Note: All course events are amalgamated in the Dashboard calendar. If all instructors use their course calendars, the Dashboard calendar becomes an overview of all coursework and events for each individual student. (See below **Add an event to a calendar**).

Dates for scheduled events are highlighted. When a student or an instructor hovers their mouse over the date, events happening on the dates appear. Each course item listed as a result of an activity created by an instructor is a hyperlink to the activity.

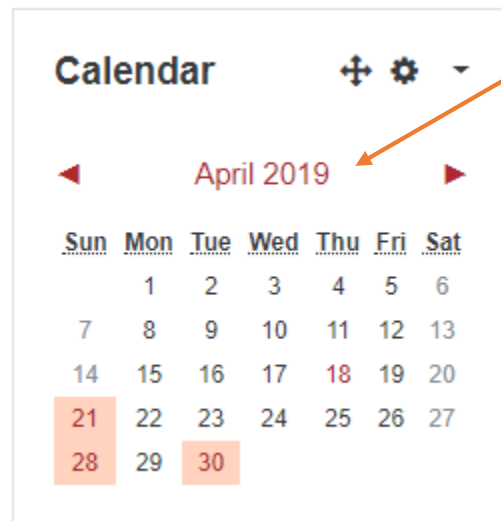
The image shows two identical Moodle Dashboard calendar blocks side-by-side. Each block is titled 'Calendar' and shows the month of April 2019. The calendar grid has days of the week as columns. In both calendars, the dates 21 and 28 are highlighted in orange. A tooltip is visible over the date 21 in the left calendar, titled 'Sunday, 21 April events', listing 'New Moodle Demo 1: S1 Assignment: Persuasive Essay Causes of WWI is due' with a document icon. The right calendar also shows dates 21 and 28 highlighted.

Students may also input '**User**' items into their Dashboard calendars. Perhaps students want to input a study group schedule.

Most instructors use their Outlook calendar to schedule work events; however, the Moodle calendar may be a choice for events related specifically to their course. An instructor may use the Moodle calendar to identify meetings pertaining to their Moodle course.

To **Add an event to a calendar**

1. Select the **Month**.



2. Select **New event**.

Calendar

Detailed month view for:

All courses

◀ March 2019

April 2019

May 2019 ▶

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
	1	2	3	4	5	6

New event

- Complete the details of the new event. Give an **Event title** that is explicit so that users are able to identify the event by the title. Give necessary event details in the **Description**. Choose the **Date** and **Duration**. If it is during a specific time of the day or a repeated event, click on **Show more...** If the event is repeating, input a suitable number into the **Repeat weekly, creating altogether** box.

New event

Event title

Date

18

April

2019

13

47

Type of event

Course

Course

No selection

Search

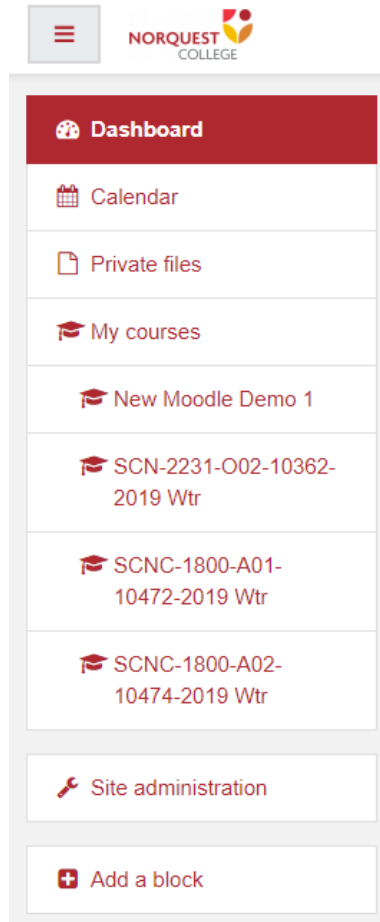
There are required fields in this form marked .

Show more...

Save

- Save Changes.**

Navigation: The **Navigation Pane** appears at the left of your Dashboard and any other Moodle pages you visit. On the Dashboard, the Navigation Block contains a menu with the Dashboard, Courses, and course specific items (eg. Participants, Badges, Grades). Each item listed is a link to that resource.



Upcoming Events lists calendar events in order. The titles of the Moodle activities are also links to the Moodle activities.

Upcoming events



S1 Assignment:
Persuasive Essay Causes of WWI is due
Sunday, 21 April, 12:00 AM



S1 Assignment: "Rick Mercer"-style rant video is due
Sunday, 28 April, 12:00 AM

Student Help Side Blocks on their Dashboard

Excellent links to resources may be found on the students' NorQuest Moodle Dashboard. **Moodle Help** assist students in being successful with Moodle and **NorQuest Links** provide information on how to be successful as a NorQuest student and lists available support services. See links below:

Moodle Help	NorQuest Links
How to Find a Course	Counselling Services
How to use the Course Book	Funding Your Education
How to complete an Online Quiz	Student Policies
How to upload and submit an Assignment	Skills for Student Success
How to view your Grades	Student Careers & Employment
	Student Judicial Affairs
	Students' Association
	Tutorial Services
	Writing Centre
	Upgrading Online
	Support Centre
	More...
	   

Dashboard Center Blocks

Course Overview: The course overview lists the courses for which you have been the instructor, both past and present. The courses are sorted into **'In progress'**, **'Future'**, and **'Past'** tabs, based on the course start date in Moodle. Click on a tab to view courses in that category. Click on the **Timeline** tab to see upcoming activity due dates (which can be sorted by date or by course).

Course overview

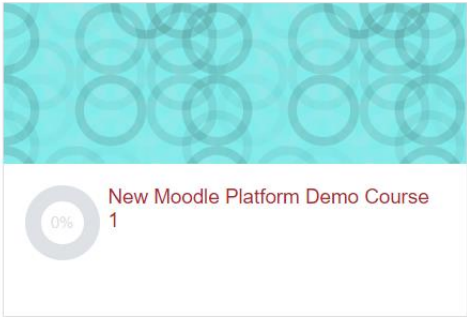
Timeline

Courses

In progress

Future

Past





Sort by dates

Sort by courses

Next 30 days

 S1 Assignment: "Rick Mercer"-style rant video is due to be grad... New Moodle Platform Demo Course 1	30 Apr, 13:00	Grade 1
 S1 Assignment: Persuasive Essay Causes of WWI is due to be ... New Moodle Platform Demo Course 1	30 Apr, 13:00	Grade 1

NOTE: If you would like a Course Overview similar to the one you may have used in Moodle in the past (ie. A list of courses, of which ones you aren't using are hidden), you can get this back by clicking on **Customise this page**, and then **Add a block** in the **Navigation Pane**. From the popup menu, select **Course Overview on Campus**. You can then move and delete blocks as desired to customize your dashboard. You can also click on **Reset page to default** to reset your dashboard back to the default.

Course overview





 New Moodle Platform Demo Course 1	
SCN-2231-Biology 20-O02-2019 Wtr	
SCNC-1800-Academic Science-A01-2019 Wtr	
SCNC-1800-Academic Science-A02-2019 Wtr	

You have 0 hidden courses | [Manage hidden courses](#)

Dashboard Tabs The tabs are found on all pages through Moodle. These tabs assist the user in easily navigating and accessing resources.



Library: The library tab takes you to the NorQuest Library Homepage.

NorQuest College Library

My NEOS | Moodle | My Mail | MyQuest

Search the NorQuest Library Site

Lpass
Library Pass

Learn about L-Pass

Make your NorQuest ID card your Edmonton Public Library Card and enjoy the benefits of the EPL membership.

Search Catalogue

Search books, articles & more...

Everything Articles Books Videos

Focus Search

NEOS Libraries

Search WorldCat

Book a Room

Media rooms contain a computer, DVD player, VHS player, large screen TV, whiteboard, table and chairs. Each room will accommodate 6 people.

Book Media Room

APA Citation & Format Guide

Need help with APA? This guide provides useful information and examples.

My Quest: The My Quest link is a link to the **People Soft Student** login page. See below:



User ID

Password

[Forgot Password/ Forgot User ID](#)

Sign In

Help for Students

The following student options are available if you need assistance:

Phone: 780.644.6085 or toll free 1.866.534.7218

Email: computercommons@norquest.ca

In-Person: Computer Commons, Downtown campus, Heritage Tower, 5th Floor

Note: Please have your student ID number, home address and phone number available before contacting Computer Commons. Email requests must include this information.

Help for Faculty & Staff

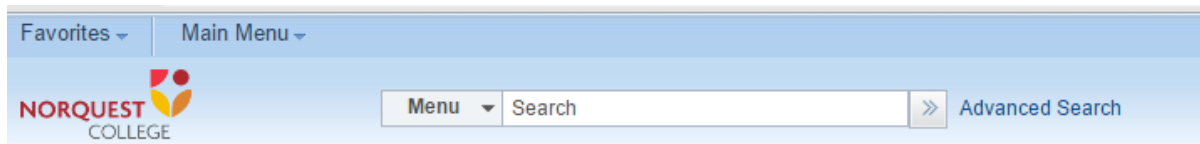
For assistance contact the **Service Desk** by phone or email. You can also go to PeopleSoft Support on the **Q** for additional information.

NorQuest Passwords: 8 characters minimum, one special character (%?!@#), one number and one capital letter. Passphrases are encouraged.

[Click on this link](#) for more details.

People Soft **Help for Students** and **Help for Faculty & Staff** are available. Besides contacting the Service Desk, faculty should consult the [Learning Registration Network](#) (LRN) to check for courses offered by CLTD (College Learning, Teaching and Development).

Once you are logged in, you are able to access the People Soft for Students site by using the drop down menu in the tab **Main Menu**.



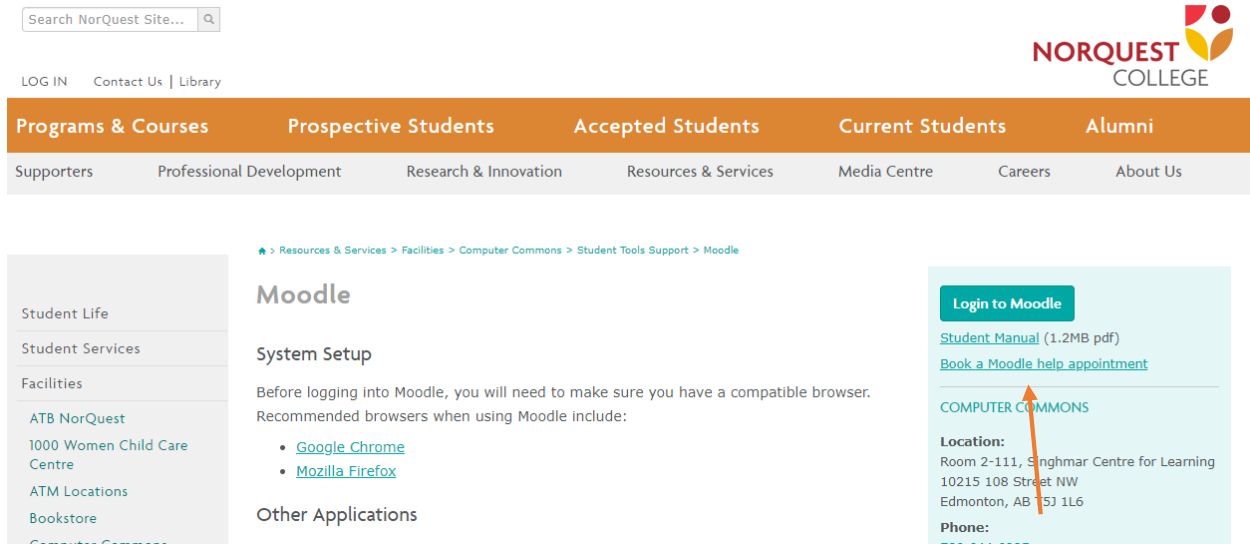
My Mail: The **My Mail** link accesses the MyNorQuest email box for the student. Most instructors will not use this link because they do not have a MyNorQuest email account. Note, once **My Mail** is selected, the prompt supports student access to their NorQuest email. (Students NorQuest emails contain @mynorquest.ca.) See below:



Sign in to continue to Gmail

The sign-in form is a light gray box. At the top is a circular profile picture placeholder. Below it is a text input field with the placeholder text "Enter your email". Under the input field is a blue button labeled "Next". To the right of the "Next" button is a link that says "Need help?". Below the entire sign-in box is a link that says "Create account". A tooltip box is positioned to the right of the sign-in box, containing the text "Please enter your full email address" and "example@mynorquest.ca" with a close button (an 'x' in a square) in the top right corner. An orange arrow points from the top right towards the tooltip.

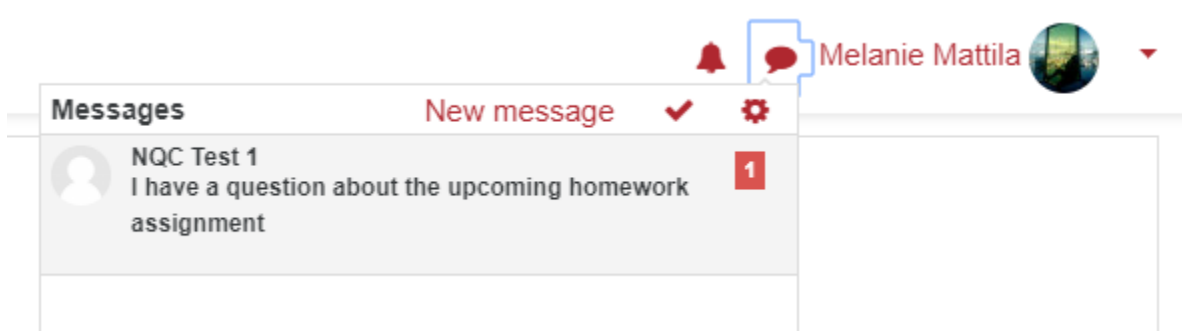
Technical Support: Another tab offering support to students is Technical Support. Note : Students are able to book appointments to get assistance with Moodle.



The screenshot shows the NorQuest College Moodle Dashboard. At the top, there is a search bar and navigation links for LOG IN, Contact Us, and Library. Below this is a horizontal menu with tabs for Programs & Courses, Prospective Students, Accepted Students, Current Students, and Alumni. Under the Programs & Courses tab, there are links for Supporters, Professional Development, Research & Innovation, Resources & Services, Media Centre, Careers, and About Us. The main content area is titled 'Moodle' and includes a breadcrumb trail: Resources & Services > Facilities > Computer Commons > Student Tools Support > Moodle. The 'Moodle' section has a 'System Setup' subsection with a warning about browser compatibility and a list of recommended browsers: Google Chrome and Mozilla Firefox. There is also an 'Other Applications' section. On the right side, there is a 'Login to Moodle' button and links to the 'Student Manual' (1.2MB pdf) and a 'Book a Moodle help appointment'. Below this is a 'COMPUTER COMMONS' section with location and phone information. A red arrow points to the 'Book a Moodle help appointment' link.

Notifications and Messages icons: Sending correspondence through Moodle is easy and recommended. Moodle will keep track of all conversations between you and your students. Students and instructors may view their mail within Moodle. You will also get the email sent to your NorQuest email account. The **Bell** icon gives you systems notifications like assignments and quizzes submitted, while the **Speech bubble** icon shows correspondence between you and your students.

The mailbox below shows NQC Test 1 has one unread message. However, all emails sent to this student through Moodle are still available to view.

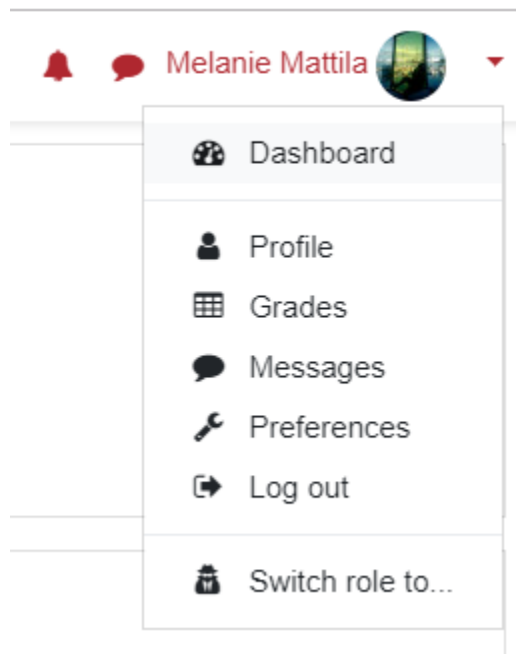


The screenshot shows the Moodle Messages mailbox. At the top, there is a header with the name 'Melanie Mattila' and a profile picture. Below this is a 'Messages' section with a 'New message' button and a checkmark icon. The mailbox contains a single message from 'NQC Test 1' with the subject 'I have a question about the upcoming homework assignment'. A red square with the number '1' indicates one unread message. The message content is partially visible: 'I have a question about the upcoming homework assignment'.

When the user selects the message, the message appears. The user may respond by using the **Message** text box. (See below)

The screenshot displays a Moodle message interface. On the left, a sidebar contains a 'Search messages' input field, a profile card for 'NQC Test 1' (Online) with the message 'I have a question about the...', and a bottom navigation bar with 'Messages' and 'Contacts' icons. The main content area shows the selected message from 'NQC Test 1' dated 'Thursday, 18 April 2019' at '3:10 PM', with the text 'I have a question about the upcoming homework assignment'. An 'Edit' link is visible in the top right of the message area. A red 'Reply' button is located to the right of the message content, with an orange arrow pointing from it to the 'Write a message...' text box in the bottom right corner. The 'Send' button is also visible next to the text box.

User tab: The user tab has a drop down menu with some useful features.



Switch role to...: This feature allows you to switch your viewing mode into another role's view. For example, a faculty member with the Teacher role may want to see what students see on the Moodle course page, so will select 'Student'.

Preferences: When beginning to use Moodle, it is important to set your Preferences, which includes editing your profile. An instructor requires a visible online identity. It is important that a profile include a picture, and a 'brief' synopsis of career highlights or expectations for the course they are teaching. Even when teaching face-to-face (F2F), students who use social media expect these profiles to be up-to-date. Editing your Profile is considered paramount and is discussed in greater detail in the Edit Profile Cheat Sheet.

Also, under preferences you are able to change your password, decide on settings for messages, set how blogs are displayed, and display/download badges earned in courses. After you have used Moodle for a period of time, it is recommended and may be particularly useful to view the default settings under **Notification preferences**. After attaining experience with Moodle, you will be able to decide if you want notifications for assignments, postings to forums and quizzes, and how messages and notifications will appear when you are logged into Moodle, etc..

For more information, contact Moodle Help at moodle@norquest.ca.